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Bending Spoons

UX/UI designer, WeTransfer
Warsaw, Poland

Dear Bending Spoons team,

WeTransfer is one of the few products I have used for years without ever needing an explanation, and that is the hardest thing to design. I have spent five years on the opposite kind of surface, dense technical systems where nothing is obvious, learning how to take a tangled problem and turn it into an interface someone can move through with confidence. That is the craft I would bring to a product millions of people already trust.

At Nacos Marine I led UI and UX end-to-end for vessel monitoring products across web, desktop and onboard HMI, shipped to **13 000+ ships** and around **30 000 daily users**. The work I am proudest of is subtraction: I restructured the information architecture from first principles, cutting navigation from **four or five levels of nested menus to two** and consolidating **22 functions into 10**, which cut time-to-task execution by **70%** and got operators off the manual for their core tasks. I worked next to product owners and engineers from the first sketch rather than handing designs over, defining UX requirements early and making decisions the build could actually carry. After one release, the customer came back and ordered a second interface. Earlier, at Cytiva, I redesigned the internal hour-tracking system and cut daily task time for **500+ employees**, and I designed and co-developed a desktop ordering tool, so I know where the design ends and the code begins.

My process is human-centered and evidence-led. I draw out the non-obvious needs through research and co-creation, narrow them into one well-defined problem, and get to something testable quickly, using AI tools where they let me explore more directions than I could by hand and reach an interactive prototype instead of a description of one. It comes from an MSc in Human-Centered AI at DTU, which I finished with **10.56 out of 12** while working full time, and where the question that kept me busy was where a system should act on its own and where the person stays in control. I co-designed an AI storytelling system for children that lets the child set the direction at each turn while the model generates within guardrails, and I researched and tested a mobile reading app for low-vision users to understand how a system can step in without breaking a reader's focus.

I am ambitious in the way the posting describes, and I would rather be held to a rising bar than a comfortable one. I have moved for work and study before, to Copenhagen, Krakow, Tokyo and Lisbon, so being in Milan for the first months is not an obstacle but the part I would look forward to. Outside work I shoot, colour and edit short documentaries from my travels, which is the same instinct as the job: notice the detail.

Warmly,

Gabriela Penarska